

Cosmic Shore

Re-run on 21 September against `bleeding-edge` , nine days after Revision 4. **The six-week window the plan was written against closed on 11 September.** Engineering kept arriving; this run corrects three claims Revision 4 got wrong; and a same-day owner report closes the largest unknown on the board — **fresh builds run, multiplayer included.**

AUDITED	PREVIOUS	BRANCH	PLAN OF RECORD
21 Sep 2026	Rev 4 · 12 Sep	bleeding-edge 0eef7c5b	Rev 2 · 31 Jul — window elapsed

NOT COVERED
Off-machine work; editor runtime

DAYS PAST THE PLAN'S OWN WINDOW 10 Six weeks from 31 July ended 11 September. No week-one gate has been cleared.	NEW GAME MODES SINCE "0 LEFT TO BUILD" 19 Measured by mode id against 31 July. 1,966 commits in the same window.	QA VERDICTS 1 Unchanged since 14 August — now 38 days old, against 25 live modes.	PROGRESSION SYSTEM Wired Closed 21 Sep, after three audits. Live in <code>Menu_Main</code> . Persistence is the new blocker.
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DEFINITION OF DONE 2/8 Unchanged from Revision 4. The four that cannot pass are the same four.

The owner reports that **fresh builds have been installed and run correctly, multiplayer features included**, with the note that it *"needs everyday testing but it works"*. That closes the largest single unknown this series has carried: whether a Windows player runs at all.

Second, the progression blocker closed. `claude/ftue-editor-tool-69acq5` merged to `bleeding-edge` at `f6a7303a4`, putting a live, configured `GameModeProgressionService` in `Menu_Main` after three audits called its absence the project's blocking item. Section 04 is rewritten against the merged tree rather than left standing. The merge reverted one ecology hitchhiker, kept another with its collider-budget impact stated, and flipped neither kill-switch — and it too records that **nothing was opened in Unity**.

Neither is a verdict. There is no entry in `Docs/QA/RESULTS/`, no build id and no log, so the project still holds **one** recorded verdict — from 14 August. Every figure in this document was measured before the report and none of them moves: the recording is what is missing, not the testing. R1 is re-marked 🟡 on the board rather than closed.

01 THE WINDOW CLOSED, AND THE PLAN DID NOT NOTICE

Revision 2 was written on 31 July with a six-week calendar path. That path ended on **11 September**. Every prior audit measured the project against the plan's *content*; this one starts by measuring it against the plan's *clock*, because that is the number an investor reads first and no checkpoint has stated it.

Week one of that plan required a Steamworks partner account, the Direct fee paid, and an app record created. `Tools/Steam/upload.sh` still opens with the line *"NOTHING HERE RUNS UNTIL THE APP EXISTS ON STEAMWORKS"*, and both `STEAM_APPID` and `STEAM_DEPOTID` remain unset required variables. On the repository's own evidence, **week one has not happened**. Weeks two through six each depend on it.

THE PREMISE THAT EXPIRED FIRST

Revision 2's headline was **"0 features left to build"** and *"feature-complete"*. That was true when written. Measured from the commit at 31 July to `0eef7c5b` : **1,966 commits** (1,535 non-merge), **19 new game-mode ids**, and enabled scenes in build settings **15 → 33**.

The new modes are Cleave, Wildlife Liberation, Dog Fight, The Bends, Scarab Scramble, Salvo, Switchback, Hijack, Tollway, Headlong, Breakwater, Skein, Bloomrush, Redline, Wrecking Ball, Undertow, Regatta, Broadside and Online Duel for the Cell. This is not a criticism of the work — it is uniformly high quality. It is that **the thing being shipped is no longer the thing that was scoped**, and every validation estimate in the plan was sized against the smaller game.

02 THREE CORRECTIONS TO REVISION 4

An audit is only worth its own accuracy. Three of Revision 4's statements do not survive re-measurement, and the first one moves the project's risk position in the right direction.

REV 4 SAID	VERDICT	WHAT THE TREE SHOWS
"Nothing in CI builds a Windows player."	WRONG	<code>.github/workflows/unity-ci.yml</code> runs a weekly IL2CPP Windows player build on a self-hosted runner via <code>CosmicShoreBuildPipeline.BuildWindowsRelease</code> , and a <i>Verify build output</i> step fails the job unless <code>CosmicShore.exe</code> exists. The scheduled run of 17 September was green , as were 7 of the last 10. The step existed at Revision 4's own base commit. A Windows player is being built — and, per the owner report below, one has now been run.
R14 "Not started" — licence register and launch-blocker index.	STALE	It landed the <i>same day</i> as the audit (PRs #871 and #873, merged 12 Sep from a branch since deleted). <code>bleeding-edge</code> carries the  . More importantly the one verified compliance gap — FMOD EULA clause 3 requiring an in-game "FMOD / Firelight Technologies Pty Ltd." credit on every tier — is closed and gated : <code>Assets/Resources/CreditsManifest.asset</code> , a release build guard, and <code>check_credits_manifest.py --check</code> , which passes.
"54 red + 3 amber = 57 open items" in the verification checklist.	DISPUTED	Counting section markers gives 45 red + 1 amber + 1 green = 46 open , and the checklist's <i>own banner</i> states 46. The two counts use different units; 57 is not reproducible. The conclusion is unaffected — none of them has been absorbed into QA — but the figure should not be quoted.

03 WHAT MOVED IN NINE DAYS

MEASURE	REV 4 · 12 SEP	NOW · 21 SEP	READING
Live arcade modes	21	25	Arcade 21 + Arena 4 (Regatta, Broadside new)
GameModes members	51	55	
Scenes in build settings	29	33	2 further entries disabled (tool scenes)
Vessel slots named	26/32	29/32	Rhino +1, Serpent +2
Level-5 upgrades authored	22/32	23/32	Net +1, including one regression — see below
QA backlog items	64	68	62 never run
QA backlog scan date	13 Aug	13 Aug	Now 39 days stale
QA verdicts on record	1	1	Unchanged since 14 Aug
Progression service	absent	absent	All four sub-claims re-verified
Friend-request callers	0	0	The growth model's own mechanism

A LEVEL-5 UPGRADE WAS REMOVED, NOT ADDED

The net +1 hides a subtraction. `ElementalAbilityMaps/Scarab.asset` line 53 now carries an empty `UpgradeLabel` where it read *Armored Switch* at Revision 4 — cleared deliberately when the switch's prism fill was retired. Its `AbilityLabel` still reads "Switch", so the slot counts as **named** while its upgrade no longer exists. Open design slots are now Rhino elements 1 and 3, and Serpent element 2.

04 THE BLOCKING FINDING, CLOSED THE SAME DAY

For three audits the quest and progression system was not part of the build. As of 21 September it is. `claude/ftue-editor-tool-69acq5`

merged to bleeding-edge at f6a7303a4 , and what follows is the old finding with its current state against each line.

The service FIXED. Menu_Main.unity now carries a live GameObject named GameModeProgressionService — m_IsActive: 1 , m_Enabled: 1 — which DontDestroyOnLoad s itself in Awake .	Its only host FIXED. The orphan prefab under Migration_Prefabs (DELETE LATER) still exists and is no longer the only host. Verified independently on bleeding-edge @ f6a7303a4 .	The config FIXED, and this is the one that mattered. progressionConfig now resolves to ProgressionConfig.asset . Every prior audit found this field empty, which is what made the authored unlock list dead.
What it does NOT do Two kill-switches ship unflipped. DeveloperUnlockGate.DefaultAllUnlocked is true, so everything stays unlocked and QuestGraphRunner.TryStart returns early — the quest graph does not run by default. And ProgressionBackendGate.CloudEnabled is false, so progression does not persist to Cloud Save.		

Definition of Done #4 therefore MOVES rather than closes. It asks for unlocks and progression persisting through Cloud Save; the service now exists and is configured, and persistence is deliberately switched off. The blocker is no longer *"instantiated by nothing"* — it is *"a one-line flag, and the test pass behind it"*. That is a materially different and much smaller problem.

05 NEW THIS RUN: WHAT AN OUTSIDER WOULD SEE FIRST

The invite build is the first thing anyone outside the studio will touch. Three defects sit on that surface, and none appeared in any tracker.

Seven shipped strings
the font cannot draw

FIXED + GATED

The UI font carries 97 glyphs with an **empty fallback table**, so a character outside it renders as an empty box with nothing logged. **Five of the seven were on the connecting / arena-build screen** — the screen every player sees on every match. Fixed this pass; `Tools/Build/check_tmp_glyph_coverage.py` now reads coverage off the font asset and fails CI, with 12 self-test controls.

A shipped card points
at a scene that is not in
the build

OPEN

`ArcadeGameCoOpWildlifeBlitz` names `MinigameWildlifeBlitzMultiplayerCoOp`, which exists on disk but is **not in build settings**. Launching it from a player build fails. Separately, **20 of 51** arcade cards name scenes that do not exist at all — all legacy single-player, none on a live roster.

The STORE screen is
unreachable

OPEN

`StoreScreen.cs` is a real 234-line implementation with no entry in `ScreenSwitcher`'s screens list, so the commerce de-scope branch that would mark it is dead code. Not broken — *absent*. Related: the Arena button is authored **Available** in `Menu_Main.unity` while the code comment describes Arena as behind a lock.

AND A THEME SYSTEM NOTHING READS

UI redesign task T4 is marked **DONE**. `UIThemeS0` exists; five of its ten colour tokens and *every* spacing, geometry and motion token have zero C# call sites, and the only reference is one unused `[SerializeField]`. The tracker's own text concedes a code-only task cannot close it. Tasks T2, T5, T6, T7 and T8 remain open, and T5/T6 have been invalidated by a later style decision rather than completed.

06 WHAT ACTUALLY STOPS A STEAM RELEASE

Ordered by what blocks the most behind it. Nothing on this list is blocked on building a feature.

#

BLOCKER

OWNER

WHY IT BLOCKS

1 No Steamworks app exists

HUMAN

H1/H2. The upload script refuses to run without it. Carries external identity, tax and banking lead time, so it cannot be compressed later. Gates DoD #1 and #2 and all of workstreams A and E.

#	BLOCKER	OWNER	WHY IT BLOCKS
2	No validation has ever run	HUMAN	R1/R2/R3. One QA verdict in the project's history, 38 days old. Backlog 39 days stale at 68 items, 62 never run. 46 checklist items never absorbed. A Windows player builds weekly and, per the owner report, now runs with multiplayer working — but none of it is <i>recorded</i> , so R2 still cannot absorb the backlog behind it. Gates DoD #3.
3	Progression does not persist	SESSION	Downgraded 21 Sep. The service is wired and configured. What remains is <code>ProgressionBackendGate.CloudEnabled = false</code> , which keeps quest progress in a local PlayerPrefs mirror so every session starts fresh. Flipping it is one line; proving it is a test pass. DoD #4 waits on that, not on the service existing.
4	No load-time target	SESSION	R7. The target <i>is</i> the deliverable and does not exist. The matrix is now $25 \times 4 = 100$ combinations, up from the ~28 the original estimate assumed. Gates DoD #5.
5	Licence and entitlement tail	HUMAN	FMOD credit is closed and gated. Still open: the FMOD <i>tier</i> decision against the \$600k/\$200k thresholds; the SOAP receipt (128 first-party files, not removable); the Wwise evaluation-licence question (per-title, survives deleting the folder); "Effects Library" provenance; and vendoring the DOTween and NativeShare notices.
6	Playtest dual-appID pipeline	SESSION	R6. <code>upload.sh</code> still renders exactly one app/depot pair. A Playtest child app is a second target, and the wave runbook does not exist.
7	Six multiplayer fixes, unplaytested	HUMAN	B18–B23 plus Presence B1/B4/B6 are all 🟡 — fixed, never run. Among them: a client could not leave a match, and a lost scene transition was a permanent black screen. These came from <i>playing</i> , not from a tracker.
8	Art and store copy	HUMAN	H13–H15. Capsules in five sizes, trailer, screenshots. 13 person-days on one contributor, and the store page cannot go live without the capsule set.

07 DEFINITION OF DONE · 2 OF 8

No criterion changed in nine days. One improved in its evidence without changing state.

1	Steam page live with Playtest signup. The app record does not exist; R6 has no runbook.	BLOCKED
2	Playtest build approved, waves granted, invites on. A player builds weekly and green, and the owner reports one running with multiplayer — but there is still nowhere to upload it.	BLOCKED
3	Fresh install → four-player Tournament, zero P0/P1. Unproven. B18–B23 show the defect class is real and only visible from play.	UNPROVEN
4	Quest chain completes, unlocks persist. Service wired 21 Sep; persistence still off by flag.	MOVED
5	Load time meets target in every mode. No target published; the matrix grew to 100 cells.	NO TARGET
6	Telemetry cohorted by wave. Client half met — <code>invite_wave</code> on the person record, envelope clean. Dashboards still to build.	CLIENT MET
7	Zero public review surface. Structural.	MET
8	Gate published, exit checklist signed. Measurable since R9; publishing and signing are still H12.	HALF

The verdict held for five weeks and moved on the day this was written. **Nothing on this milestone is blocked on building something** — and one of its three legs came off on 21 September, when the wiring decision was taken and the progression service went live. It is now blocked on one account registration, one *flag* (`ProgressionBackendGate.CloudEnabled`), and a validation pass scoped in July that has still not begun. What has changed is the denominator: the validation pass now faces **25 modes and 100 load-time cells** instead of the game the plan was written against. The engineering continues to arrive well ahead of plan; the evidence that any of it works does not exist.

THE ONE RECOMMENDATION THIS AUDIT WILL MAKE

Every session-lane item that can be closed has been closed, and closing more of them does not move a single Definition-of-Done criterion. The next unit of work with any leverage is **one person, one afternoon, one Windows build**

launched on one machine — it unblocks R2 and R3, converts 46 checklist rows and 68 backlog items from "never run" into data, and is the only way the B18-B23 class of defect is ever found. It has been the top of the board since Revision 3.